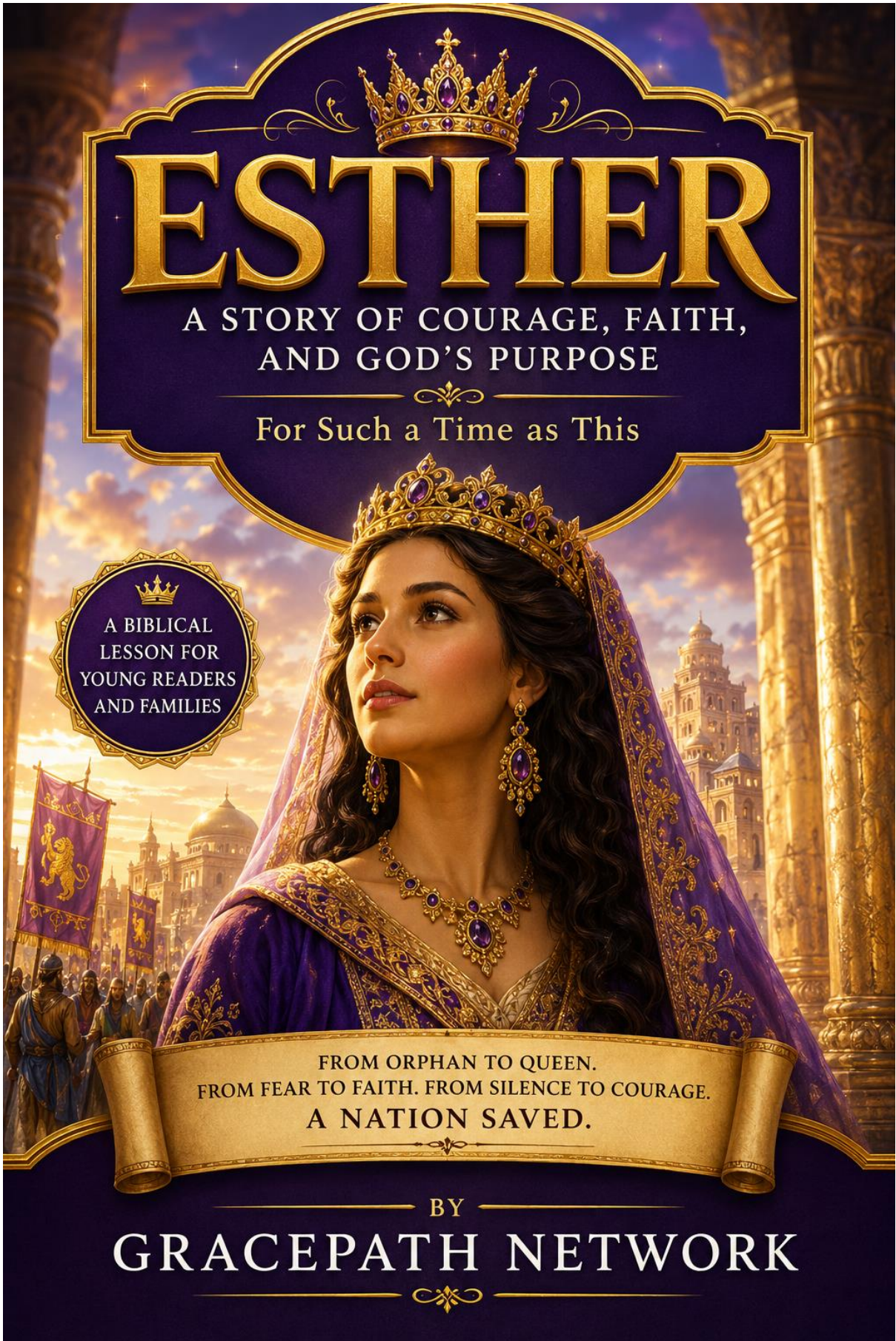


The poster features a woman with long dark hair, wearing a purple and gold crown and a matching purple and gold robe. She is looking upwards and to the left. The background shows a city with domes and minarets, and a large golden column. The title 'ESTHER' is written in large, golden, serif letters. Below it, the subtitle 'A STORY OF COURAGE, FAITH, AND GOD'S PURPOSE' is written in smaller, white, serif letters. Below that, the phrase 'For Such a Time as This' is written in a smaller, golden, serif font. A circular badge on the left side contains the text 'A BIBLICAL LESSON FOR YOUNG READERS AND FAMILIES'. At the bottom, a golden scroll contains the text 'FROM ORPHAN TO QUEEN. FROM FEAR TO FAITH. FROM SILENCE TO COURAGE. A NATION SAVED.' Below the scroll, the text 'BY GRACEPATH NETWORK' is written in white, serif letters.

ESTHER

A STORY OF COURAGE, FAITH,
AND GOD'S PURPOSE

For Such a Time as This

A BIBLICAL
LESSON FOR
YOUNG READERS
AND FAMILIES

FROM ORPHAN TO QUEEN.
FROM FEAR TO FAITH. FROM SILENCE TO COURAGE.
A NATION SAVED.

BY
GRACEPATH NETWORK

QUEEN ESTHER

Introduction

Have you ever felt afraid to do something important?

Perhaps you wanted to stand up for a friend who was being treated unfairly. Maybe you knew the right thing to do but worried about what others might think. Fear is something everyone experiences, even the bravest people.

The story of Queen Esther teaches us that true courage is not the absence of fear. Courage is choosing to do what is right even when we feel afraid.

Esther's journey begins with hardship. She was a young girl who lost her parents and grew up far from her homeland. Yet God had a special plan for her life. Through a series of remarkable events, Esther became queen of the most powerful empire in the world.

Life in the palace may have looked perfect, but Esther would soon face a challenge greater than she could have imagined. Her people were in danger, and she had to decide whether to remain silent or risk everything to help them.

With faith in God, wise counsel from her cousin Mordecai, and a heart willing to obey God's purpose, Esther stepped forward at the moment her people needed her most.

Her story is a powerful reminder that God often places ordinary people in extraordinary situations. He gives strength to those who trust Him and courage to those who are willing to stand for truth.

As you read this book, you will discover lessons about bravery, faith, wisdom, kindness, leadership, and purpose. You will see how God worked behind the scenes to protect His people and how one young woman's obedience changed the course of history.

Although Esther lived thousands of years ago, her story still speaks to us today. Each of us will face moments when we must choose between fear and courage, silence and action, comfort and doing what is right.

When those moments come, remember the words that changed Esther's life:

"Who knows whether you have come to the kingdom for such a time as this?" (Esther 4:14)

Perhaps God has placed you exactly where you are for a special purpose too.

So turn the page and step into the inspiring story of Queen Esther—a story of bravery, purpose, faith, and standing for what is right.

May her journey encourage you to trust God, walk in courage, and discover the purpose He has for your life.

By GracePath Network

QUEEN ESTHER

Chapter 1: The Orphan Girl God Had Not Forgotten

"The Lord is close to the broken-hearted and saves those who are crushed in spirit." — Psalm 34:18

The city of Susa was one of the most important cities in the Persian Empire. Its streets were filled with merchants selling colourful fabrics, spices, and precious goods from distant lands. Travellers from many nations passed through its busy markets every day.

Among the thousands of people living there was a young Jewish girl named Esther.

At first glance, there seemed to be nothing unusual about her. She did not live in a palace. She did not come from a wealthy family. She was not famous or powerful.

In fact, Esther's life had begun with great sadness.

When she was very young, both of her parents died. The loss left a deep emptiness in her heart. While other children ran home to their mothers and fathers, Esther often felt the pain of knowing that her parents would never return.

There were moments when she wondered why such a difficult thing had happened to her.

Sometimes, especially at night, she would look at the stars and remember the stories her parents had once told her. She missed their smiles, their voices, and the comfort of their presence.

But even in her sorrow, God had provided someone to care for her.

Her older cousin, Mordecai, took Esther into his home and raised her as his own daughter.

Mordecai loved Esther deeply. He made sure she had food to eat, clothes to wear, and a safe place to live. More importantly, he taught her about God.

Every evening, Mordecai shared stories about God's faithfulness.

He told her about Abraham, who trusted God when he did not know where he was going.

He told her about Joseph, who remained faithful even when he was treated unfairly.

He told her about Moses, who led God's people out of slavery.

As Esther listened, her faith grew stronger.

"Remember, Esther," Mordecai often said, "God never abandons His people. Even when life is difficult, He is still working."

Esther treasured those words.

The Jewish people were living in Persia because many years earlier they had been taken from their homeland and brought into exile.

Although they now lived among people from many cultures, they continued to worship the one true God.

Life was not always easy.

Many Jews missed their homeland. They missed Jerusalem, the city of their ancestors. They longed for the day when they could fully enjoy the blessings God had promised His people.

Esther often listened as older members of the community shared stories about their homeland.

She imagined the beautiful city of Jerusalem, the temple where God's people worshiped, and the great acts God had performed throughout Israel's history.

These stories filled her heart with hope.

Although she had never seen Jerusalem herself, she felt connected to her people's history and faith.

As Esther grew older, people began to notice her.

She was beautiful, but her beauty was much more than what could be seen on the outside.

She had a gentle spirit.

She was respectful toward others.

She was patient and kind.

If someone was carrying a heavy basket, Esther offered to help.

If a neighbour was sick, Esther visited and encouraged them.

If children argued, Esther often helped them make peace.

People trusted her because they knew she cared about others.

Mordecai was proud of the young woman she was becoming.

One afternoon as they walked through the marketplace, Mordecai smiled and said, "Esther, true beauty comes from a good heart. Never forget that."

Esther nodded.

She knew that outward beauty fades, but character lasts a lifetime.

Years passed, and Esther continued to grow in wisdom and maturity.

Yet she still faced questions that she could not answer.

Why had she become an orphan?

Why had God allowed her family to suffer loss?

Why were the Jewish people living far from home?

Why did life sometimes seem unfair?

Like many people, Esther did not understand everything that was happening around her.

But she chose to trust God anyway.

She learned that faith does not mean having all the answers.

Faith means believing that God is good even when we do not understand His plans.

Every challenge Esther faced was shaping her character.

Every disappointment was teaching her perseverance.

Every lesson from Mordecai was preparing her for the future.

Though she did not realize it, God was working behind the scenes.

He was preparing Esther for a purpose far greater than she could imagine.

One evening, after finishing her daily chores, Esther sat outside and watched the sun slowly disappear beyond the horizon.

The sky glowed with shades of gold, orange, and red.

As she looked upward, countless stars began to appear.

She remembered something Mordecai had taught her.

"God sees every star in the sky," he had said. "And if He cares for the stars, He certainly cares for you."

The thought brought peace to her heart.

No matter how uncertain the future seemed, Esther knew she was not forgotten.

God knew her name.

God knew her story.

God knew her future.

And although she could not yet see it, God was leading her toward a destiny that would change the lives of countless people.

The young orphan girl living quietly in Susa would soon find herself at the centre of one of the greatest stories of courage in history.

The next chapter of Esther's life was about to begin.

Chapter 1 Reflection

1. How did Mordecai help Esther after she lost her parents?
2. What qualities made Esther beautiful on the inside?
3. Why is it important to trust God even when we do not understand everything?
4. What lessons was Esther learning before she became queen?
5. How does Esther's story encourage you when facing difficulties?

Life Lesson

God never forgets His children. Even during difficult seasons, He is preparing us for the purpose He has planned for our lives.

Chapter 2: The Search for a Queen

"Trust in the Lord with all your heart and lean not on your own understanding." — Proverbs 3:5

Esther's life had been quiet and simple.

She spent her days helping around the house, learning from Mordecai, and serving those around her. She had no idea that events were unfolding that would soon change her life forever.

Far away in the magnificent royal palace, King Xerxes ruled over a vast empire stretching across many lands. His kingdom was one of the largest and most powerful in the world.

The palace itself was breath-taking.

Tall marble pillars lined the grand halls. Beautiful gardens surrounded the royal grounds. Gold and silver decorations sparkled in the sunlight. Servants hurried through the corridors carrying out the king's commands.

People throughout the empire admired the king's wealth and power.

Yet despite all his riches, the king faced a problem.

The throne beside him was empty.

The kingdom needed a queen.

Soon, a search began across the empire. Officials were sent to gather young women from every province. The most beautiful and graceful women would be brought to the palace and presented before the king.

News of the search spread quickly.

People talked about it in marketplaces, homes, and city streets.

No one in Susa could avoid hearing about it.

One day, Esther learned that she too had been selected to go to the palace.

The news filled her with uncertainty.

Everything she had known was about to change.

She would leave the familiar comfort of Mordecai's home and enter a world she had never imagined.

That evening, Esther sat quietly with Mordecai.

Neither of them spoke for a long time.

Finally, Mordecai broke the silence.

"Esther," he said gently, "we may not understand why this is happening, but God does. Trust Him."

Esther nodded.

She had learned throughout her life that God could be trusted, even when His plans seemed mysterious.

Still, leaving home was not easy.

The next morning, Esther gathered her belongings and prepared for the journey.

As she walked away, Mordecai watched with both pride and concern.

He prayed that God would guide and protect her wherever she went.

When Esther arrived at the palace, she was amazed.

Everything seemed larger than life.

The royal gardens stretched as far as she could see. Colourful flowers bloomed everywhere. Fountains sparkled in the sunlight. Servants moved about dressed in fine clothing.

Many young women had already arrived from different parts of the empire.

Some came from wealthy families.

Others came from noble households.

Many were eager to impress those around them.

Esther, however, remained humble.

She did not boast about herself.

She did not try to draw attention.

Instead, she treated everyone with kindness and respect.

Soon she met Hegai, the official responsible for caring for the women.

Unlike many others, Esther listened carefully to his advice.

She showed gratitude and cooperation in everything she did.

Hegai quickly noticed her character.

There was something different about Esther.

Her beauty was matched by wisdom, humility, and grace.

As a result, he showed her special favour and provided her with the best care.

Although Esther appreciated the kindness she received, she never allowed it to make her proud.

She remembered the lessons Mordecai had taught her.

True greatness comes from humility.

Months passed as the women prepared for their appearance before the king.

Each woman spent time learning palace customs and receiving special treatments.

Many focused only on improving their appearance.

Esther, however, focused on something more important.

She continued to trust God.

Each day she prayed for wisdom and guidance.

She knew that her future was in God's hands.

Whenever she felt nervous or uncertain, she remembered how God had cared for her throughout her life.

If God had been faithful before, He would be faithful again.

Meanwhile, Mordecai often walked near the palace grounds.

He wanted to know how Esther was doing.

Although he could not see her directly, he remained close enough to hear news about her well-being.

His concern never faded.

He prayed constantly for her safety.

Finally, the day came when Esther would stand before the king.

Her heart raced as she entered the royal court.

The magnificent room was unlike anything she had ever seen.

Golden decorations covered the walls.

Rich carpets stretched across the floor.

Royal guards stood at attention.

At the centre sat King Xerxes.

For a moment, Esther felt small and insignificant.

But then she remembered something important.

God was with her.

Taking a deep breath, she stepped forward.

The king looked carefully at Esther.

There was a quiet confidence about her.

Her beauty was undeniable, but it was her gentle spirit that truly captured attention.

The king was pleased.

More than any other woman he had seen, Esther found favour in his eyes.

Then something remarkable happened.

King Xerxes chose Esther to become queen.

A royal crown was placed upon her head.

A great celebration followed throughout the kingdom.

The orphan girl who had once wondered whether anyone noticed her had now become queen of the Persian Empire.

Yet Esther did not allow her new position to change her heart.

She remained humble.

She continued to honour Mordecai's guidance.

She continued to trust God.

Although she now lived in a palace, she remembered where she came from.

She remembered the struggles of her people.

She remembered the lessons she had learned during difficult times.

Most importantly, she remembered that every blessing came from God.

As celebrations filled the palace, Esther could not yet see the challenges that lay ahead.

She did not know that her position as queen would soon become part of God's plan to save an entire nation.

For now, she simply trusted Him one step at a time.

And God continued to guide her journey.

Chapter 2 Reflection

1. How did Esther react when she was chosen to go to the palace?
2. What qualities caused others to favour Esther?
3. Why is humility important when receiving success or blessings?
4. How did Mordecai continue to support Esther?
5. What does Esther's story teach us about trusting God's plan?

Life Lesson

God often opens doors we never expected. When He does, we should walk through them with humility, faith, and gratitude.

Chapter 3: Life in the Palace

"Whoever can be trusted with very little can also be trusted with much." — Luke 16:10

The celebration of Esther becoming queen lasted for many days.

People throughout the empire talked about the beautiful young woman who had captured the king's heart. Musicians played joyful songs, servants prepared magnificent feasts, and guests gathered to celebrate the king's choice.

For Esther, however, becoming queen was more than receiving a crown.

It was the beginning of a new responsibility.

She now lived in the royal palace, surrounded by luxury and privilege. Servants attended to her needs. Beautiful garments filled her chambers. The finest foods in the kingdom were placed before her.

Everything around her spoke of wealth and power.

Yet Esther remembered the lessons she had learned as a child.

She knew that a person's value is not measured by possessions or status but by character.

The crown on her head did not change the kind of person she wanted to be.

She remained kind.

She remained humble.

And most importantly, she remained faithful to God.

Each morning, Esther woke early and spent quiet moments reflecting on the goodness of God.

The palace was often busy and noisy, but she understood the importance of staying connected to the One who had guided her throughout her life.

Whenever she looked around at her new surroundings, she remembered how far God had brought her.

She thought about the little house where she had lived with Mordecai.

She remembered the difficult days after losing her parents.

She remembered the times she had wondered about her future.

Now, standing in the palace as queen, she could see that God had been leading her every step of the way.

Not because life had been easy, but because God had been faithful.

Although Esther's position had changed, her relationship with Mordecai remained strong.

Mordecai continued to visit the area near the palace gates where many royal officials gathered.

Whenever possible, he checked on Esther's well-being.

He offered wisdom and encouragement just as he had done throughout her childhood.

Esther valued his advice.

She understood that wise counsel is a gift.

Many people become proud when they gain power and stop listening to those who care about them.

Esther chose a different path.

She remained teachable.

She continued to respect Mordecai and the lessons he had taught her.

Because of this, she grew not only as a queen but also as a person.

One day, something unusual happened.

As Mordecai sat near the king's gate, he overheard a secret conversation.

Two palace guards were angry with King Xerxes.

They were discussing a dangerous plan.

The men intended to harm the king.

Mordecai listened carefully.

His heart raced as he realized the seriousness of what he had heard.

If the plot succeeded, the king's life would be in danger.

Mordecai knew he had to act quickly.

He immediately sent word to Queen Esther.

Esther listened carefully to the message.

Without delay, she informed the king about the conspiracy and explained that Mordecai had uncovered it.

The matter was investigated.

The king's officials discovered that the report was true.

The plot was stopped, and the king's life was saved.

Everything that happened was carefully recorded in the royal records.

Although Mordecai received no immediate reward, his act of loyalty was not forgotten.

God had seen it.

And in the future, it would become very important.

As the months passed, Esther continued learning what it meant to be queen.

She discovered that leadership involved much more than wearing beautiful robes or attending royal events.

Leadership required wisdom.

Leadership required integrity.

Leadership required serving others.

Every day brought new responsibilities.

There were decisions to make, people to listen to, and situations to understand.

Esther realized that influence should never be used for selfish purposes.

Instead, it should be used to help others and honour God.

This understanding made her different from many leaders around her.

While others sought power for themselves, Esther sought to do what was right.

One evening, as Esther walked through the palace gardens, she reflected on her journey.

The moon shone brightly overhead.

A gentle breeze moved through the trees.

The gardens were peaceful and quiet.

She thought about how quickly life had changed.

Not long ago she had been an orphan girl living in Mordecai's home.

Now she was queen of a vast empire.

Yet despite all the changes, one thing remained the same.

God was still guiding her.

She did not know what challenges lay ahead.

She could not see the future.

But she trusted the One who could.

Little did Esther know that a great danger was already beginning to develop within the kingdom.

A proud and ambitious man named Haman was rising to power.

His decisions would soon threaten the lives of Esther's people.

And when that moment came, Esther would face the greatest test of courage she had ever known.

For now, she continued to serve faithfully, unaware that God was preparing her for a purpose that would affect an entire nation.

Chapter 3 Reflection

1. Why did Esther remain humble after becoming queen?
2. What important lesson did Esther learn about leadership?
3. How did Mordecai help protect the king?
4. Why is it important to listen to wise counsel?
5. How can we use influence and responsibility to help others?

Life Lesson

Success should never cause us to forget our values. God blesses us so that we can serve others and remain faithful to Him.

Chapter 4: Haman's Evil Plan

"Pride goes before destruction, a haughty spirit before a fall."
— Proverbs 16:18

The Persian Empire was peaceful and prosperous. King Xerxes ruled over many lands, and people from different nations lived under his authority.

In the royal palace, life continued as usual.

Servants carried out their duties. Officials attended important meetings. Merchants travelled through the kingdom. Families went about their daily lives.

Yet beneath the surface, a great danger was growing.

A man named Haman had risen to one of the highest positions in the kingdom.

Haman was intelligent, ambitious, and powerful. The king trusted him and gave him great authority over many affairs of the empire.

When Haman walked through the palace gates, people noticed him immediately.

His fine robes showed his importance.

His servants followed behind him.

Many people bowed low before him as a sign of respect.

At first, Haman enjoyed the honour he received.

But over time, his desire for recognition became something unhealthy.

The more respect he received, the more he wanted.

The more people honoured him, the more he expected it.

Instead of being grateful, Haman became proud.

And pride was beginning to control his heart.

Every day, as Haman entered the king's gate, people bowed before him.

They lowered their heads and showed respect for his position.

Everyone did this—except one man.

Mordecai.

When Haman passed by, Mordecai remained standing.

He did not bow.

He did not kneel.

He did not worship Haman.

Some of the palace officials noticed.

"Mordecai," they asked, "why do you refuse to bow before Haman?"

Mordecai answered simply.

"I worship God alone."

Mordecai respected authority, but he knew that worship belonged only to the Lord.

Day after day, he remained faithful to his beliefs.

He would not compromise his faith, even when others pressured him.

When Haman learned about Mordecai's refusal, he became furious.

At first, he could hardly believe it.

How could someone refuse to honour him?

Did Mordecai not understand his power?

Did he not realize who Haman was?

The more Haman thought about it, the angrier he became.

His pride was wounded.

Instead of ignoring the matter, he allowed his anger to grow.

Soon, thoughts of revenge filled his mind.

But Haman's hatred did not stop with Mordecai.

When he learned that Mordecai was a Jew, his anger spread to all the Jewish people.

He decided that one man was not enough.

He wanted to destroy an entire nation.

It was a cruel and evil plan.

Haman carefully approached King Xerxes.

He knew he needed the king's approval to carry out his scheme.

Speaking respectfully, Haman said,

"There is a certain people scattered throughout your kingdom. Their customs are different from everyone else's. They do not follow the king's laws as others do. It is not in the king's best interest to tolerate them."

Haman deliberately hid the truth.

He did not mention that these people were the Jews.

He did not mention that they were peaceful citizens.

He did not mention that Queen Esther herself was Jewish.

Instead, he presented a distorted picture designed to influence the king.

Then Haman offered a large amount of money to support the plan.

The king listened and eventually agreed.

Without fully understanding the consequences, he authorized a decree.

A royal order was written and sent throughout the empire.

On a specific day, all Jews were to be attacked and destroyed.

The decree was sealed with the king's authority and distributed to every province.

When the news spread, fear swept through the Jewish communities.

Families gathered in shock.

Parents worried about their children.

Grandparents prayed for protection.

No one could believe what they were hearing.

The future suddenly seemed uncertain.

People cried openly in the streets.

Many put on sackcloth and ashes, traditional signs of mourning and grief.

The entire Jewish community was filled with sorrow.

Among them was Mordecai.

When he learned about the decree, his heart was broken.

He tore his clothes, put on sackcloth, and cried out in anguish.

He knew that thousands of innocent lives were at risk.

He also knew that time was running out.

Something had to be done.

Inside the palace, Esther had not yet heard the full details of the decree.

When she learned that Mordecai was mourning outside the king's gate, she became deeply concerned.

She sent a messenger to discover what had happened.

Soon the terrible news reached her.

The Jewish people faced destruction.

The decree had already been issued.

The danger was real.

Esther was shocked.

Her heart filled with sadness and fear.

The people she loved were in danger.

Her own life was in danger.

Yet she did not know what to do.

The situation seemed impossible.

How could one woman stand against such a powerful decree?

How could she influence the king?

How could she save an entire nation?

Questions filled her mind.

But God was preparing Esther for the moment she had been placed in the palace to face.

Far beyond what Esther could see, God was still at work.
Though evil appeared strong, it would not have the final word.
Though Haman's plan seemed unstoppable, God had a greater plan.
The same God who had cared for Esther as an orphan had not abandoned His people now.
A decisive moment was approaching.
Soon Esther would face the greatest choice of her life.
Would she remain silent?
Or would she risk everything to stand for what was right?
The answer would change history.

Chapter 4 Reflection

1. What caused Haman to become angry with Mordecai?
2. Why did Mordecai refuse to bow to Haman?
3. How did Haman's pride lead him to make evil decisions?
4. How did the Jewish people respond when they heard the decree?
5. What challenge was Esther about to face?

Life Lesson

Pride can lead people down a dangerous path, but faithfulness to God gives us strength to stand for what is right, even when it is difficult.

Chapter 5: For Such a Time as This

"Be strong and courageous. Do not be afraid or discouraged, for the Lord your God will be with you wherever you go." — Joshua 1:9

The news of Haman's decree spread quickly throughout the Persian Empire.

In cities, towns, and villages, Jewish families gathered together in fear and sadness. Parents worried about the future of their children. Elders prayed for God's mercy. Many people wept openly as they thought about the terrible danger that lay ahead.

The entire Jewish community was shaken.

Among those mourning was Mordecai.

Dressed in sackcloth and ashes, he stood outside the king's gate crying out in grief. His heart was heavy as he thought about the suffering that could soon come upon his people.

Inside the palace, Queen Esther heard about Mordecai's condition.

She was deeply concerned.

Why was Mordecai mourning so openly?

What had happened that caused him such sorrow?

Esther immediately sent one of her attendants to speak with Mordecai and discover the reason.

When the messenger arrived, Mordecai explained everything.

He told him about Haman's hatred.

He described the king's decree.

He explained that every Jewish man, woman, and child was now in danger.

Then Mordecai did something important.

He sent a copy of the decree to Esther.

He wanted her to understand the seriousness of the situation.

Most importantly, he urged her to go before the king and plead for mercy on behalf of her people.

When Esther received the message, fear filled her heart.

She understood what Mordecai was asking.

But she also knew the risk.

According to Persian law, anyone who approached the king without being invited could be put to death.

The only exception was if the king extended his golden sceptre as a sign of favour.

If he did not extend the sceptre, the person would die.

Esther had not been called to see the king for thirty days.

What if he rejected her?

What if he became angry?

What if she lost her life?

The thought terrified her.

She sent a message back to Mordecai explaining her concerns.

Surely he would understand.

Surely he would realize how dangerous this was.

But Mordecai's response challenged Esther in a way she had never been challenged before.

His message was direct and powerful.

"Do not think that because you are in the king's palace you alone will escape," he said.

"If you remain silent at this time, help and deliverance for the Jews will arise from another place, but you and your family will miss the opportunity God has given you."

Then Mordecai spoke words that would be remembered for generations:

"And who knows but that you have come to your royal position for such a time as this?" (Esther 4:14)

When Esther heard those words, she became silent.

She thought deeply about them.

For such a time as this.

Could it be true?

Could God have brought her from a small home in Susa to the throne of Persia for this very purpose?

Could every challenge she had faced have been preparing her for this moment?

Could her position as queen be part of God's plan to save His people?

The more Esther thought about it, the more she realized that Mordecai was right.

This was not simply about her safety.

This was about God's purpose.

For a while, Esther wrestled with fear.

She was human.

She understood the danger.

She knew the cost could be very high.

Yet she also knew that remaining silent would not be the right choice.

True courage is not the absence of fear.

True courage is choosing to do what is right despite fear.

As Esther prayed, her faith began to grow stronger than her fear.

She remembered all the times God had guided her in the past.

She remembered His faithfulness throughout her life.

She remembered how He had cared for her when she was an orphan.

If God had brought her this far, He would not abandon her now.

Finally, Esther made her decision.

She sent a message back to Mordecai:

"Go and gather all the Jews in Susa. Fast for me. Do not eat or drink for three days and three nights. My attendants and I will do the same."

Then she added words that revealed her courage:

"After that, I will go to the king, even though it is against the law. And if I perish, I perish."

Those words did not mean Esther had given up hope.

They meant she had fully surrendered herself to God's will.

She was willing to do what was right no matter the cost.

Mordecai received the message and immediately obeyed.

Throughout the city, Jewish people joined together in prayer and fasting.

Families prayed in their homes.

Friends gathered to seek God's help.

Young and old alike called upon the Lord.

They knew that their hope was not in human power but in God's faithfulness.

For three days, Esther fasted and prayed.

She spent time seeking God's wisdom and strength.

She did not rush ahead in her own ability.

She first prepared her heart before the Lord.

As the days passed, a deep peace began to replace her fear.

The situation had not changed.

The danger was still real.

But Esther had changed.

Her confidence was now rooted in God rather than in circumstances.

She understood that courage does not come from feeling strong.

It comes from trusting the One who is strong.

At last, the third day arrived.

The time for prayer and fasting had ended.

The moment of decision had come.

Esther carefully put on her royal robes.

She looked into the mirror and took a deep breath.

Her heart beat rapidly.

Everything that happened next could change the future of her people.

The palace halls seemed quieter than usual as she walked toward the king's court.

Each step reminded her of the risk she was taking.

Yet she continued forward.

She would not turn back.

She would not allow fear to control her.

She would trust God completely.

As Esther approached the entrance to the throne room, she silently prayed one final prayer.

Then she stepped into the court.

The king looked up.

The fate of Esther—and her people—hung in the balance.

Chapter 5 Reflection

1. Why was Esther afraid to approach the king?
2. What did Mordecai mean when he said, "For such a time as this"?

3. How did prayer and fasting help Esther?
4. What does true courage look like?
5. Has there ever been a time when you had to do the right thing even though you were afraid?

Life Lesson

God places us in certain situations for a purpose. When we trust Him, He gives us the courage to do what is right, even when it is difficult.

Chapter 6: Haman's Deadly Request

"Pride goes before destruction, and a haughty spirit before a fall." — Proverbs 16:18

The night after Esther's first banquet, Haman could hardly contain his excitement.

As he walked home through the streets of Susa, his head was held high.

The queen herself had invited him to dine with the king.

Not just once.

Twice.

In all the empire, only three people would attend the second banquet—King Xerxes, Queen Esther, and Haman.

The thought filled him with pride.

"I must be the most important man in Persia," he thought.

The more he thought about it, the happier he became.

But then he saw someone sitting near the king's gate.

Mordecai.

As usual, Mordecai did not bow.

He did not kneel.

He did not even acknowledge Haman's presence.

The sight immediately ruined Haman's mood.

His face darkened.

His fists clenched.

How could one man rob him of his joy?

When Haman arrived home, he gathered his family and closest friends.

For hours he boasted about his achievements.

"My wealth is greater than anyone else's."

"My position is higher than all the other officials."

"The king trusts me."

"The queen invited only me to her banquet."

His guests nodded and praised him.

Yet despite all his accomplishments, Haman remained unhappy.

Then he finally admitted why.

"All of this means nothing to me as long as I see Mordecai the Jew sitting at the king's gate."

The room became silent.

His wife, Zeresh, spoke first.

"If Mordecai is the problem, then remove him."

The others agreed.

"Build a gallows seventy-five feet high. In the morning ask the king for permission to execute Mordecai. Then you can enjoy the banquet."

Haman's eyes lit up.

It was exactly what he wanted to hear.

"Excellent!" he exclaimed.

Immediately workers were summoned.

Throughout the night they laboured under torchlight.

The enormous gallows rose into the sky above Susa.

By dawn everyone could see it.

And everyone knew it had been built for Mordecai.

The next morning Haman awoke with a smile.

Today would be a perfect day.

First, Mordecai would be executed.

Then he would attend Queen Esther's banquet.

Everything was going according to plan.

Or so he thought.

Wearing his finest robes, Haman hurried to the palace.

He could barely wait to present his request to the king.

As he entered the palace courtyard, he imagined how satisfying it would be to see Mordecai gone forever.

He rehearsed the words in his mind.

"Your Majesty, I request permission to execute Mordecai."

Simple.

Direct.

Effective.

He was certain the king would agree.

After all, Haman was the king's most trusted advisor.

Nothing could go wrong.

But inside the palace, something had already changed.

The previous night, the king had been unable to sleep.

God had quietly begun to turn the situation around.

And Haman was about to discover that his plans were falling apart.

The proud official who came seeking Mordecai's death would soon receive the greatest shock of his life.

Chapter 6 Reflection

1. Why was Haman unable to enjoy his success?
2. What role did pride play in his decisions?
3. Why did he build the gallows?
4. What mistake did Haman make about his importance?
5. How can pride prevent people from appreciating God's blessings?

Life Lesson

Pride blinds us to reality and often leads us toward destruction.

Chapter 7: The Most Humiliating Parade in Persia

"God opposes the proud but shows favour to the humble." — James 4:6

Haman entered the palace expecting victory.

Instead, he walked into disaster.

Before he could mention Mordecai, the king spoke first.

"Haman, what should be done for the man the king delights to honour?"

Haman nearly smiled.

Surely the king was talking about him.

Who else could it be?

Who else deserved such honour?

His imagination began to race.

He pictured crowds cheering.

He imagined people bowing lower than ever before.

This was finally the recognition he deserved.

Or so he believed.

Trying not to appear too eager, Haman answered carefully.

"If the king wishes to honour someone, let him be dressed in royal robes worn by the king himself."

The king nodded.

Encouraged, Haman continued.

"Place the man on the king's own horse, one with a royal crest on its head."

The king nodded again.

Haman's confidence grew.

Then he added,

"Let one of the king's highest officials lead the horse through the city streets proclaiming: 'This is what is done for the man the king delights to honour!'"

Haman could almost hear the crowds already.

The king smiled.

"Excellent idea."

Haman's heart swelled with pride.

At last.

His moment had arrived.

Then came the words that shattered his dreams.

"Go at once," said the king.

"Take the robes and the horse and do exactly as you have suggested for Mordecai the Jew, who sits at the king's gate."

For a moment Haman thought he had misunderstood.

Surely the king had spoken incorrectly.

Mordecai?

The Jew?

The man he hated?

The man he planned to execute?

The king repeated the command.

"And do not neglect anything you have recommended."

Haman felt the blood drain from his face.

There was no escape.

No argument.

No protest.

The king had spoken.

Soon the streets of Susa were filled with people.

Word spread rapidly.

Something extraordinary was happening.

People rushed from homes and marketplaces.

Merchants abandoned their stalls.

Children ran through the streets.

Crowds gathered to watch.

And what a sight they saw!

Mordecai was dressed in the king's royal robes.

He rode upon the king's horse.

And leading the horse was none other than Haman.

The most powerful official in Persia.

The man who wanted Mordecai dead.

Now forced to honour him.

Step after painful step, Haman walked through the streets.

His head hung low.

His pride was shattered.

Yet he had no choice but to obey.

Again and again he shouted:

"THIS IS WHAT IS DONE FOR THE MAN THE KING
DELIGHTS TO HONOR!"

The crowd cheered.

People pointed.

Some laughed in amazement.

Others whispered to one another.

"Isn't that Haman?"

"Why is he honouring Mordecai?"

"How strange!"

Each shout felt like a wound to Haman's pride.

Every street seemed longer than the last.

Every cheer from the crowd deepened his humiliation.

The entire city of Susa watched as the proud man praised the very person he despised.

When the parade finally ended, Mordecai quietly returned to the king's gate.

He remained humble.

He did not boast.

He did not mock Haman.

He simply returned to his duties.

But Haman hurried home in shame.

Covering his face, he told his family everything that had happened.

For the first time, fear entered their hearts.

His advisors spoke carefully.

"If Mordecai is of the Jewish people, and you have begun to fall before him, you will not overcome him."

Even as they spoke, servants arrived from the palace.

The king and queen were waiting.

Haman was summoned to Esther's second banquet.

He went unwillingly.

His confidence was gone.

His pride was broken.

And he had no idea that something even greater awaited him at the banquet.

The God who had been working behind the scenes was about to complete His plan.

Life Lesson

God is able to humble the proud and honour those who remain faithful to Him.

Chapter 8: Esther's Bold Accusation

"The righteous are as bold as a lion." — Proverbs 28:1

Haman arrived at Queen Esther's second banquet with a troubled heart.

Only one day earlier, he had imagined himself becoming the most honoured man in Persia.

Instead, he had spent the entire morning leading Mordecai through the streets of Susa, publicly proclaiming his honour.

The memory still burned within him.

Every shout.

Every cheer from the crowd.

Every step beside Mordecai's horse.

His pride had been wounded.

Yet he still believed he could recover.

Perhaps the banquet would improve his fortunes.

Perhaps the queen had some special favour to grant him.

Perhaps things were not as bad as they seemed.

He entered the banquet hall and took his place beside the king.

Queen Esther greeted them warmly.

No one except Esther knew what was about to happen.

The meal began peacefully.

Servants brought the finest foods in Persia.

Golden cups sparkled in the candlelight.

Musicians played softly in the background.

For a time, conversation flowed easily.

Then the king turned toward Esther.

For the third time he asked:

"Queen Esther, what is your request? Even if it is half my kingdom, it shall be given to you."

The room became quiet.

Esther knew this was the moment she had prayed for.

The moment she had fasted for.

The moment God had prepared her for.

Taking a deep breath, she rose from her seat.

"If I have found favour in your eyes, Your Majesty," Esther began, "grant me my life—this is my request. And spare my people—this is my petition."

The king looked puzzled.

"Who threatens your life?" he asked.

Esther continued.

"For we have been sold to destruction—to be killed and wiped out. If we had merely been sold as slaves, I would have remained silent. But this matter concerns the lives of innocent people."

The king's expression changed instantly.

His eyes widened.

His voice thundered through the hall.

"Who would dare do such a thing?"

"Where is this man?"

"Who has the courage to threaten my queen?"

Every servant froze.

The musicians stopped playing.

Silence filled the room.

Then Esther slowly turned.

Her hand pointed across the table.

Straight at Haman.

"The adversary and enemy is this wicked Haman."

The words struck like lightning.

Haman's face turned pale.

His mouth fell open.

For the first time in his life, he found himself speechless.

The king stared at Haman in disbelief.

The trusted advisor.

The man he had promoted.

The man he had honoured.

The man who had manipulated him.

And worst of all, the man who wanted to destroy the queen herself.

King Xerxes exploded with anger.

Unable to contain his fury, he rose from the table and stormed into the palace garden.

His footsteps echoed through the corridors.

The king needed a moment to think.

His mind raced.

How had he been deceived?

How had he allowed such a wicked decree to be signed?

How had Haman hidden the truth?

Meanwhile, inside the banquet hall, Haman realized his world was collapsing.

Every dream.

Every ambition.

Every plan.

All of it was crumbling before his eyes.

And now there was only one thing left to do.

Beg for mercy.

Chapter 8 Reflection

1. Why was Esther's accusation so shocking?
2. Why did the king become angry?
3. What emotions do you think Haman felt at that moment?
4. How did Esther demonstrate courage?
5. Why is speaking truth important even when it is difficult?

Life Lesson

God gives courage to those who trust Him and stand for truth.

Chapter 9: The Fall of Haman

"Whoever digs a pit will fall into it." — Proverbs 26:27

The banquet hall had become a place of fear.

Only moments earlier Haman had been one of the most powerful men in the empire.

Now he was a desperate man facing judgment.

As King Xerxes remained in the garden, Haman threw himself at Esther's feet.

"Please, Your Majesty!" he cried.

"Spare my life!"

His voice trembled.

Gone was the proud official who demanded honour from others.

Gone was the arrogant man who had planned the destruction of an entire people.

Now he was terrified.

Esther remained seated on her couch.

She said nothing.

Haman continued pleading.

He moved closer.

His hands grasped the edge of Esther's royal robe.

Desperation had completely overtaken him.

He clung to the queen, begging for mercy.

"Please save me!"

"Please help me!"

Tears streamed down his face.

The mighty Haman had become a broken man.

At that very moment, King Xerxes returned from the garden.

The doors opened suddenly.

The king stepped inside.

And what did he see?

Haman leaning over the queen's couch.

His hands clutching Esther's robe.

His body close to the queen.

The scene shocked him.

In his anger, he immediately assumed the worst.

The king's face turned red with rage.

His voice echoed through the hall.

"Will he even assault the queen while I am in the palace?"

The accusation stunned everyone.

Servants gasped.

Officials stared in disbelief.

The moment those words left the king's mouth, Haman knew it was over.

His fate was sealed.

Immediately palace guards rushed forward.

They covered Haman's face.

In Persia, this was a sign that a condemned man would never again look upon the king.

The once-powerful official was now treated as a criminal.

No one listened to his explanations.

No one listened to his pleas.

The judgment had been made.

As guards seized him, Haman realized the terrible truth.

The trap he had prepared for Mordecai was about to become his own.

Then one of the king's servants stepped forward.

"Your Majesty," he said, "Haman has built a gallows seventy-five feet high beside his house."

The king frowned.

"What was it built for?"

"For Mordecai," replied the servant.

"The very man who saved the king's life."

The room became silent.

The irony was impossible to ignore.

The man who wanted Mordecai dead had unknowingly prepared the instrument of his own downfall.

The king did not hesitate.

"Hang him on it."

The command was final.

Guards immediately led Haman away.

Through the streets of Susa they marched him.

The same streets where he had recently boasted of his greatness.

The same streets where he had been forced to honour Mordecai.

Now the people watched as he was led away in chains.

Whispers spread through the crowds.

The mighty Haman had fallen.

As the sun began to set, the sentence was carried out.

The gallows Haman had proudly built for Mordecai became the place of his own judgment.

The proud man who sought to destroy others had been destroyed by his own wickedness.

The king's anger subsided.

Justice had been done.

And God's people were one step closer to deliverance.

Throughout history, people would remember the lesson of Haman's downfall.

Pride may rise high for a season.

Evil may appear powerful for a time.

But God sees everything.

He defends the innocent.

He honours the faithful.

And in His perfect timing, justice prevails.

The story was not finished.

One final challenge remained.

The decree against the Jewish people still existed.

But now Queen Esther and Mordecai would work together to save a nation.

Life Lesson

Those who seek to harm others often become trapped by their own schemes, but God remains faithful to those who trust Him.

Chapter 10: A Nation Saved

"If God is for us, who can be against us?" — Romans 8:31

The palace was filled with activity after Haman's downfall.

News spread quickly throughout the kingdom that the powerful official who had plotted against the Jewish people had been removed from his position. Many were shocked by the sudden turn of events.

For Queen Esther, however, the work was not yet finished.

Although Haman was gone, the decree he had created still remained in effect.

The law still threatened the lives of thousands of innocent people.

The Jewish families throughout the empire were still in danger.

Esther knew she could not stop now.

She had already shown courage by revealing Haman's wicked plan. Now she would need courage once again to ensure the safety of her people.

King Xerxes gave Haman's estate to Queen Esther.

It was a sign of his trust and favour.

Esther then revealed to the king that Mordecai was not only her cousin but also the man who had raised her after the death of her parents.

The king was pleased.

He removed the royal signet ring that had belonged to Haman and gave it to Mordecai.

This was a great honour.

The signet ring represented royal authority.

Mordecai was now entrusted with an important position in the kingdom.

The orphan girl and the faithful man who had raised her were both being used by God in remarkable ways.

Yet Esther's heart remained focused on her people.

One day, she approached the king again.

This time she fell at his feet and pleaded with tears in her eyes.

She begged him to stop the disaster that threatened the Jewish nation.

The king listened carefully.

He understood Esther's concern.

But Persian law presented a challenge.

A decree sealed with the king's signet ring could not simply be revoked.

Another solution would be needed.

After considering the matter, the king gave Esther and Mordecai permission to write a new decree.

This new decree would allow the Jewish people to defend themselves against anyone who tried to attack them.

The king's scribes were immediately summoned.

They worked quickly to prepare the new law.

Copies were written and translated into the languages of the various provinces throughout the empire.

Messengers rode swift horses across the kingdom carrying the important news.

The message travelled through cities, towns, and villages.

For many Jewish families, hope began to replace fear.

When Mordecai left the king's presence, he was dressed in royal garments of blue and white, with a large crown and a fine purple robe.

People throughout the city celebrated.

The man who had once mourned in sackcloth now walked in honour.

The people rejoiced because they could see God's hand at work.

The Bible tells us that for the Jewish people there was happiness, joy, gladness, and honour.

What a difference God had made!

Only a short time earlier, fear had filled their hearts.

Now hope was growing stronger every day.

The same God who had protected Esther was protecting His people.

Eventually, the day arrived when Haman's original decree was supposed to take effect.

The enemies of the Jewish people expected victory.

Instead, they found something very different.

Because of the king's new decree, the Jews were able to defend themselves.

God gave them favour and protection.

Many officials throughout the empire supported them because they respected Mordecai's leadership and authority.

What the enemy intended for destruction became an opportunity for deliverance.

The plans of evil were defeated.

The Jewish people survived.

Families were reunited.

Communities were preserved.

Children who might have lost their future were protected.

God had turned sorrow into joy.

After the victory, celebrations spread throughout the empire.

People gathered together to thank God for His faithfulness.

There was feasting, rejoicing, and giving gifts to one another.

The Jewish people established a special celebration called **Purim**.

This annual festival would help future generations remember how God had rescued them from destruction.

Every year, families would tell the story.

Children would learn about Esther's courage.

Parents would remember God's protection.

Grandparents would share how God had turned a terrible situation into a great victory.

The story would never be forgotten.

As time passed, Queen Esther continued to serve faithfully.

She remained humble despite her position.

She never forgot where she came from.

She never forgot the God who had guided her.

Mordecai also served wisely and became one of the most respected leaders in the kingdom.

Together they worked for the good of the people.

Their lives became examples of faithfulness, integrity, and courage.

Esther's story teaches us an important truth.

God often works through ordinary people.

When Esther was a young orphan girl, no one could have imagined that she would one day save a nation.

Yet God saw her potential long before anyone else did.

He guided her steps.

He prepared her heart.

He placed her in the right place at the right time.

And when the moment came, Esther chose courage over fear.

Because she trusted God and stood for what was right, countless lives were saved.

Today, Esther's story continues to inspire people around the world.

Whenever we face difficult choices, we can remember her example.

Whenever we are tempted to stay silent when we should speak, we can remember her courage.

Whenever we wonder if God has a purpose for our lives, we can remember Esther's journey.

The same God who worked in Esther's life is still working today.

He still guides.

He still protects.

He still gives courage.

And He still uses ordinary people to accomplish extraordinary purposes.

Chapter 10 Reflection

1. Why was Esther still concerned after Haman was removed?
2. What new responsibility did King Xerxes give to Mordecai?
3. How did the new decree help the Jewish people?
4. Why was the festival of Purim established?
5. What does Esther's story teach us about God's purpose for our lives?

Life Lesson

God can use one courageous person to change the lives of many others. When we trust Him and stand for what is right, He can accomplish amazing things through us.

Conclusion: For Such a Time as This

Queen Esther's story is a story of faith, courage, wisdom, and purpose.

She began as an orphan girl, but through God's guidance she became a queen. When her people faced danger, she chose courage instead of fear and obedience instead of silence.

Her story reminds us that God has a purpose for every life.

Just as Esther was placed in the palace for a special reason, God has placed each of us where we are for a reason.

May we trust Him, walk in courage, and be willing to stand for what is right.

For who knows?

Perhaps God has called **you** for **such a time as this**.

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GracePath Network creates inspiring messages, biblical lessons, devotionals, children's books, and inspirational novels designed to strengthen faith, build character, and encourage people of all ages to walk confidently in God's purpose.

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ESTHER

A STORY OF COURAGE, FAITH, AND GOD'S PURPOSE

From an orphan girl to the queen of Persia, Esther's journey is one of faith, courage, and divine purpose. When her people faced destruction, she chose to trust God and take a stand. Her story reminds us that God sees us, prepares us, and places us for such a time as this.

IN THIS BOOK, YOUNG READERS WILL DISCOVER:



A POWERFUL TRUE STORY
from the Bible told in an engaging
and easy-to-understand way.



LIFE LESSONS THAT BUILD FAITH
about courage, obedience,
and trusting God's plan.



REFLECTION QUESTIONS
at the end of each chapter
to help build understanding and character.



ENCOURAGEMENT TO NEVER GIVE UP
because God has a purpose
for every life.



**BE INSPIRED.
BE COURAGEOUS.
BE FAITHFUL.**

Esther's story will inspire children
and families to trust God, do what is
right, and walk boldly in the purpose
He has for their lives.



**"AND WHO KNOWS
BUT THAT YOU
HAVE COME TO
YOUR ROYAL
POSITION FOR
SUCH A TIME
AS THIS?"**

— ESTHER 4:14

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